Purshotamdas asked for a copy of the committee's report, he was promptly given a printed copy.

A puzzled and frustrated Purshotamdas took his problem to Lala Lajpat Rai, the veteran Congress leader, who was in London at that time. Lalaji suggested that they consult Sidney Webb, the famous Fabian Socialist and celebrated Labour MP who had been a member of the Cabinet when Labour was in power. A meeting was arranged and Purshotamdas explained his difficulty. Webb told him that while it was true that the sub-committee had made the report, it had never been presented to the Parliament, much less approved by it. 'Ask Hilton Young to put that report in the Thames instead of handing it to you. That report is not worth the paper on which it is written,' said Webb.[23]

When Purshotamdas asked if this was a hoax played on him by the Secretary, Webb said that it was more than that. He said that it was immoral for a Chairman of a Royal Commission to mislead a dissenting member in this manner. A greatly reassured Purshotamdas took Webb's advice and asked Baxter to put his verbal communication in writing. Baxter baulked at the idea and asked Purshotamdas why he wanted such a letter. Armed with his newfound knowledge, Purshotamdas was in a position to play the aggressor. He told Baxter that he wanted to send the letter to the Prime Minister as a sample of the treatment given to a member of a Royal Commission by one of his civil servants. On the defensive Baxter had no choice but to confess that he had been acting on the Chairman's instructions. When Purshotamdas asked him to say so in writing, Baxter invited him to his office. Purshotamdas declined saying that he had no intention of seeing either Baxter or the Chairman in connection with 'this ruse'. Within half an hour Baxter conveyed to him that the Chairman had authorized him to say that Purshotamdas's Minute of dissent would be printed in full along with the report.

When this particular attempt to dissuade Purshotamdas failed, Hilton Young tried another tack: gentler persuasion through the fairer sex, the lady in question being none other than his own wife. Purshotamdas was surprised to receive an invitation to lunch from Mrs Hilton Young.[24] At the lunch she asked him to consider dropping his Minute of dissent. She tried to entice him with the offer of a Governorship of a province or even a Privy